

IK 566: Introduction to Vedic Traditions

Course Code	IK 566
Course Name	Introduction to Vedic Traditions
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D
Mutual Exclusion	None
Approval	42nd Senate (Jan 2024)

Course Contents

- **Origins and Overview:** Historical context of the Vedas; Composition and division - Ṛigveda, Sāmaveda, Yajurveda, Atharvaveda. (5 Hours)
- **Vedic Hymns and Rituals:** Exploration of select hymns; Introduction to Vedic rituals, Yajñas, and their symbolic significance. (8 Hours)
- **Brahmanas and Āraṇyakas:** Detailed study of these prose texts associated with rituals; Transition from ritualistic to meditative practices. (7 Hours)
- **Upaniṣads:** Philosophical Insights: Introducing the core philosophical teachings; Concepts of Ātman, Brahman, Māyā, and Mokṣa. (8 Hours)
- **Vedic Lifestyle and Daily Practices:** Dinacharya (daily routine); Principles of Dharma, Artha, Kama, and Moksha; Vedic calendar and festivals. (7 Hours)
- **Continuation and Evolution:** Vedāṅga (limbs of Vedas); Development of Darśanas (philosophical systems); Vedic traditions in contemporary times. (7 Hours)

Laboratory Modules

- NA

Text Books

1. Radhakrishnan, S., **The Principal Upanishads**, Harper Collins, 2006.
2. Feuerstein, G., **The yoga tradition: Its history, literature, philosophy and practice**, SCB Distributors, 2012.

References

1. Frawley, D., **The Rig Veda and the History of India**, Aditya Prakashan, 2003.
2. Veerabhadrappe, B. V., **The Bhagavad-Gītā: A Rational Enquiry**, Navakarnataka Publications Pvt Ltd, 2012.
3. Swami B. V. Tripurari, **The Aranyakas: The Philosophy of the Forest**, 2019.
4. S. Radhakrishnan, **The Principal Upanishads**, 2006.
5. Roshen Dalal, **The Vedas: An Introduction to Hinduism's Sacred Texts**, 2014.
6. Bharati Krsna Tirthaji, **Vedic Mathematics**.